

19. Nine-Mile Creek – Rice Point

Shoreline length: 31 km



Shore Types

Nine-mile Creek-Rice Point is located on the southeast end of PEI. Shore type characterized by a majority of cliffs and wetlands.

% Shore types within SMU

low plain	bluff	sloped armour	cliff	wetland	vertical struct.	dunes	sandspit
7	12	8	39	33	1	0	0



Rice Point and Camp Seggie



Nine Mile Creek Harbour



Small lots along south cliffs

Governance, Infrastructure, and Economy

This area is fully incorporated within the Rural Municipality of West River. Key infrastructure includes Route 19, the road to Canoe Cove-Cumberland; the road to Lloyd Inman Memorial Park (Canoe Cove); Camp Seggie (Rice Point); Wharf Road, the Bait Masters Inc. wharf (Bacon Cove); and Route 19 at Bacon Cove. Coastal economic drivers include the Nine Mile Creek wharf, Glen Afton Golf Course and Camp Seggie, a seasonal overnight children’s camp on the shore. Legacy land use constraints include several developed small lots on unpaved roads running parallel and perpendicular to the coast, as well as several undeveloped small lots.

Natural Assets and Heritage

Local parks include the Rice Point Wildlife Park and the Lloyd Inman Memorial Park; possibly outside the SMU boundary, Argyle Shore Provincial Park is nearby.

Coastal Flood and Erosion Risk

Erosion hazard is high along most of the cliffs while flood hazard is high in the Nine Mile Creek area. The following flood risk indicator is based on the even with 1% annual exceedance probability (100-year return) with increasing amounts of sea level rise (SLR). The erosion risk indicator is based on potential future shoreline change for areas with historical data, not including salt marshes.

Estimated number of buildings and length of road at risk [per km shoreline].

	FLOOD RISK				EROSION RISK		
	Present	Short-term 0.3m SLR (2050)	Medium-term 0.6m SLR (2080)	Long-term 1.2m SLR (2130)	Short-term (~2050)	Medium-term (~2080)	Long-term (~2130)
Buildings	1 [<1/km]	4 [<1/km]	10 [<1/km]	16 [1/km]	3 [<1/km]	13 [<1/km]	36 [1/km]
Roads	758 m [24 m/km]	878 m [28 m/km]	1201 m [39 m/km]	1693 m [54 m/km]	78 m [3 m/km]	141 m [5 m/km]	570 m [18 m/km]

The shoreline includes critical habitat for bird species including the threatened Bank Swallow.

Planning and Policy Framework

West River has municipal planning authority, applying a hard Environmental Risk zone that includes watercourses and wetlands plus 15m and the 2100 coastal floodplain, as well as other hazard areas. All building setbacks are measured from the zone boundary. Coastal setbacks are based on standard buffers plus setbacks, or 60× the annual rate of erosion where applicable. A vertical setback is included, based on the 2100 coastal floodplain.

Sediment transport

The estimated net sediment transport rate averaged across the SMU is moderate. The numerous eroding headlands typically feed pocket beaches and wetlands located in the sheltered areas.

Proposed SMP Strategies

	Short-term	Medium-term	Long-term
Sea level rise range	0 – 0.3 m	0.3 – 0.6 m	0.6 – 1.2 m
Potential timeframe	2030 - 2050	2050 - 2080	2080 - 2130
19.00 Nine-Mile Creek-Rice Point	NAI	MR	MR
Rationale	Given the initially low risk levels the proposed strategy is No Active Intervention. Mid- to long-term Managed Realignment will reduce risk to the limited number of vulnerable assets while preserving natural shorelines, including wetland and cliff habitat.		
19.01 Nine Mile Creek Harbour - PU	R	R	R
Rationale	A Resist strategy is proposed to maintain this key infrastructure at its present location. However, there is a risk of the area being flood isolated during storms. This would warrant raising the road, land and assets in addition to maintaining sea defences, subject to final strategies and local policies to be developed with the local authority.		

The table above shows how the recommended shoreline management unit (SMU) or policy unit (PU) strategy evolves across three planning epochs (Short-, Medium-, and Long-term) under increasing sea-level rise and erosion projections.

Adaptation strategies are preliminary recommendations subject to further development with feedback from community and government. These strategies are not approvals, commitments or policy determinations.